

Economic Transition Framework Project Plan

Economic security, liberty, opportunity, and distributed power

Working draft v0.1 | September 24, 2026 | Project owner: Steve Smith

Purpose and intended result

Develop and critically evaluate a framework for improving economic security and access to productive ownership while preserving personal freedom, markets, ambition, and peaceful institutional correction. The immediate result is a documented, evidence-based proposal with explicit uncertainties. Adoption, legislation, and a live pilot require later decisions.

Use the supplied conversation and working overview as the starting record. The previous three-page PDF was an abridgment and omitted the references; it should not replace the fuller discussion as the provenance record. This plan restores a traceable reference register and separates user proposals from assistant suggestions.

Scope

- Define economic security, meaningful choice, concentrated power, contestability, and capture in measurable terms.
- Compare financing, ownership, competition, governance, and transition options. Develop the education-for-service compact as a specific candidate mechanism.
- Test affordability, labor capacity, distributional effects, accessibility, coercion risks, and institutional failure. Produce a pilot design only if the evidence supports one.

Working constraints from the overview

Protect basic security during change; preserve diverse ambitions and outcomes; avoid deliberately dismantling essential capacity before alternatives work; reuse institutions where feasible; make intermediate stages useful; distribute authority; and allow future generations to revise the framework. These constraints form a provisional baseline, not a claim that their implementation is already solved.

Definition of completion for this research cycle

A versioned framework with a glossary, verified evidence register, compared policy options, reproducible cost model, service-compact specification, failure scenarios, and unresolved-decision log. Every recommendation must state its rationale, who pays, who bears risk, what could falsify it, and how it could be revised or stopped.

Recommended starting boundary: use one United States civilian case study for tractable modeling, then test transferability to other jurisdictions. This is a proposed research choice, not an agreed geographic limitation. No claim of originality or proven superiority is assumed.

Decision ownership and project controls

Preserve the status of each idea

Status	Meaning and initial examples
User proposal	Education support creates at least one year of service regardless of graduation. Disability should prompt capability-based service matching. These are design inputs, not settled legal provisions.
Working synthesis	Economic floor, wider ownership, contestable power, incremental transition, and protection of vulnerable households summarize the prior overview and remain open to refinement.
Assistant proposal	Paid service, proportional additional years, vocational eligibility, waivers, and specific governance mechanisms were suggested in the discussion. Require explicit project-owner decisions before treating them as adopted.
Empirical or legal claim	Requires a source, passage, date, jurisdiction, and limitations. A citation does not establish that the complete framework works.

Roles

Project owner: Steve sets priorities and accepts or rejects proposed principles. **Research and drafting support:** collect evidence, compare alternatives, document assumptions, and maintain versions. **Independent reviewers:** economics, public finance, labor, disability access, public administration, and law; recruitment and availability are not assumed.

Working records

- Decision log: ID, question, options, evidence IDs, decision, rationale, date, owner, and review trigger.
- Claim register: exact claim, originating message or document, source and passage, supporting or conflicting evidence, confidence, and scope limits.
- Risk register: affected people, mechanism of harm, leading indicator, mitigation, residual risk, and stop condition.
- Change log: retain prior wording and explain substantive changes. Silence or continued discussion does not count as approval.

Review rhythm

Work in focused research sessions. End each with completed outputs, changed assumptions, unresolved questions, and the next decision. Conduct a phase review before advancing; record proceed, revise, defer, or reject. Publication and outreach remain separate actions requiring explicit authorization.

Phased roadmap and acceptance gates

Phase	Work and deliverable	Exit gate
0 Foundation	Baseline charter, glossary, decision log, and complete visible-reference inventory.	Owner confirms scope and proposal status; missing history is marked.
1 Evidence	Appraise R01-R20; recover blocked references; compare relevant programs and counterevidence.	Each material claim has verified support or an explicit unresolved flag.
2 Design options	Compare economic floor, ownership, financing, governance, and service-compact alternatives.	At least two plausible alternatives and the current-system baseline assessed for each major choice.
3 Feasibility	Model budgets, household effects, workforce capacity, and implementation dependencies.	Funding and resource assumptions explicit; sensitivity tests reproducible; no assumed free labor.
4 Challenge	Run adverse scenarios and commission independent review where available.	Critical failures resolved or proposal narrowed; dissent retained.
5 Synthesis	Framework v0.2, revised executive overview, source appendix, and decision recommendations.	Owner approves an accurate statement of what is established and what remains open.
6 Conditional pilot design	Select a limited intervention and develop evaluation, funding, participant protections, and shutdown plan.	Separate approval and qualified review before any enrollment or expenditure.

Dependencies

Phase 0 precedes evidence appraisal. Design options can develop alongside research, but selection waits for sufficient evidence. Costing follows explicit eligibility and service assumptions. Challenge testing may reopen any earlier phase. A failed gate returns work for revision; it does not force a deadline-driven approval.

Effort estimate for the initial research cycle

Planning allowance: Phase 0, 4-6 hours; Phase 1, 12-20; Phase 2, 12-18; Phase 3, 16-28; Phase 4, 10-18; Phase 5, 6-10. Total: 60-100 working hours, excluding specialist review and live-pilot design. These are rough planning estimates, not commitments. At 4-6 hours weekly, allow roughly 10-25 weeks plus external review delays.

Research workstreams

A Economic security and household resilience

Specify the necessities included in a floor, eligibility, delivery routes, and geographic cost differences. Compare cash, services, and combinations. Model benefit cliffs, access failures, administrative burden, and take-up. Deliver a floor options paper and household profiles. Starting references: R06, R08, R11.

B Ownership and competitive markets

Compare employee ownership, diversified citizen funds, cooperatives, retirement participation, and profit sharing. Examine investment risk, voting rights, liquidity, portability, inheritance, and the danger of concentrating both wages and savings in one employer. Address natural monopolies and market entry. Deliver an ownership and competition options matrix. The existing references are insufficient for this workstream; add primary research and outcome evaluations.

C Governance and resistance to capture

Map who appoints, funds, audits, disciplines, and removes each decision-maker. Test donor influence, revolving doors, procurement favoritism, collusion between oversight bodies, and capture of citizen funds. Compare distributed authority with coordination costs. Deliver an authority map and threat register. Starting references: R01-R03, R19.

D Financing and real capacity

Identify start-up and recurring costs, who ultimately bears each funding mechanism, training bottlenecks, and capacity that can be reused. Compare taxation, spending reallocation, limited borrowing, and ownership returns. Deliver a cost model and resource inventory. R04, R06-R08 provide context; their settings and assumptions must be preserved.

E Education and public service

Specify the compact, compare existing programs, and test whether it adds useful capacity. Include accessible placements, completion failure, and government failure to place participants. Deliver a policy options paper and draft participant terms. Starting references: R12-R18, R20. Military programs are contextual comparisons, not automatic templates for civilian enforcement.

F Transition and public legitimacy

Compare sequencing, compensation, participation, and reversibility. Ask affected people about concrete choices and costs. Record how consultation changes proposals. Deliver an implementation sequence, evaluation design, and communication brief that discloses trade-offs. Starting references: R01, R03-R05, R09-R11.

Education for service design agenda

Retain the user proposal of a minimum one-year obligation after accepting educational support, independent of graduation. Test its operation before adopting contract language. Education participation can coexist with highly variable work capacity; placement must assess actual abilities and changing circumstances.

Decision	Options and questions to resolve
Acceptance and accrual	Does obligation begin at signing, disbursement, or enrollment? Is there a cooling-off period? How is a small or reversed payment treated? Compare fixed minimum, funded-year accrual, and a capped obligation.
Eligibility and benefit	Admissions standards, residency, prior education, program quality, tuition caps, living support, part-time study, and vocational pathways. Prevent provider price inflation and low-value enrollment.
Pay and work conditions	Assess normal salary and benefits, wage parity, hours, caregiving, relocation, part-time equivalence, and representation. Paid service is recommended but requires a recorded decision.
Placement	Define qualifying public benefit, approved employers, participant choice, local or remote work, supervision, accreditation, and a maximum placement wait. Decide what happens if government cannot provide suitable work.
Disability and hardship	Accommodation, changing capacity, episodic illness, caring duties, deferment, appeal, and genuine incapacity. No automatic assumption that studying establishes sustained employment capacity. Waiver criteria remain open.
Withdrawal and breach	Examine transfer, withdrawal, proportionate repayment, hardship relief, and government breach. Test whether the exit terms preserve practical freedom. Legal review must assess enforceability and rights.
Additional public value	Verify useful work, training and supervision costs, retention, job displacement, wage effects, and whether participants would have served anyway.
Equity	Compare participation and burden by income, disability, location, age, and family status. Examine whether wealthy participants can buy freedom from terms borne by others.

Required output: a plain-language specimen agreement plus a decision matrix, with unresolved clauses visibly marked. The agreement remains a research draft until independent legal and accessibility review and owner approval.

Feasibility model and evaluation

Keep three accounts distinct

- Fiscal account: annual public cash outlays, receipts, debt service, and contingent liabilities.
- Resource account: workers, training seats, supervision, facilities, materials, and time diverted from other activities.
- Distribution account: household costs and benefits by income, disability, region, and participation status.

Minimum costing specification

For each cohort and year, estimate education funding + participant pay and benefits + administration + accommodation + supervision + facilities and financing costs. Subtract only separately justified budget savings or receipts. Present gross costs even when net costs are reported. Public service output is a benefit to assess, not cash revenue that can automatically fund tuition.

Compare the compact with ordinary hiring, scholarships without service, apprenticeships, and targeted retention incentives. Vary enrollment, completion, placement delay, wage growth, service length, supervisory load, dropout, and long-term retention. Track discount rates and inflation assumptions; report ranges rather than a single confident forecast.

Evaluation measures

Outcome	Measurement approach
Economic security	Disposable resources after essential costs; hardship, arrears, access delays, and benefit cliffs.
Freedom and fairness	Real exit options; unwanted placement; complaints; differences in burden and access across groups.
Public capacity	Additional staffed hours or validated services relative to the baseline, adjusted for displacement and supervision.
Fiscal performance	Gross and net spending, cost per additional service unit, liabilities, and cost overruns.
Governance	Concentration of authority, conflicts, audit coverage, complaint resolution, and reversibility.

Set thresholds before a pilot, with affected participants and reviewers. Use credible comparison groups where feasible and disclose selection bias, spillovers, and uncertainty. A small successful pilot does not establish national scalability. R01 and R09-R10 inform evaluation and engagement; no numerical targets are adopted here.

Failure tests and immediate next steps

Mandatory scenario suite

Scenario	Question and proposed response
Recession or funding loss	Can existing commitments be honored? Require a funded continuity or orderly closeout plan before expansion.
Government cannot place a participant	Does the obligation become indefinite? Define a time limit, accessible alternatives, and relief.
Student leaves early or becomes unable to work	Is the burden proportionate and feasible? Test noncompletion, illness, disability, and appeals separately.
Service replaces regular jobs	Does measured capacity fall once displacement is counted? Independent staffing and wage review; suspend new placements if unresolved.
Education providers raise prices	Does the subsidy increase price rather than access? Test caps, procurement design, quality review, and exit of weak providers.
Oversight or investment fund is captured	Can affected people challenge decisions and recover control? Test independent review, removal, disclosure, and unwind procedures.
Program benefits fail to scale	Do bottlenecks or supply shortages erase gains? Require a fresh capacity assessment at each expansion.

First four working sessions

- Session 1: confirm the charter, terminology, provisional United States case study, and status labels. Open the decision and claim registers.
- Session 2: resolve R05 claim support; recover blocked references R13, R15, R17, and R18; verify current scholarship terms; identify uncited assertions.
- Session 3: compare three service-compact designs against ordinary hiring and a scholarship-only baseline. Prioritize acceptance trigger, pay, exit, and placement failure.
- Session 4: build the first cohort cost model and household scenarios. Select the most consequential unknown for deeper research.

First release package

Deliver charter v0.1, glossary, source and claim register, unresolved-decision log, research backlog, and a first compact options matrix. Subsequent releases add the feasibility model, challenge results, and revised overview. No numerical benefit, cost, or transition date becomes an established fact solely because it appears in a draft.

Conversation reference register

All 20 distinct links visible in the supplied conversation are retained below. Earlier conversation content was truncated, so this cannot certify completeness for unseen messages. URLs omit tracking parameters. Retrieval check: September 25, 2026 UTC. Retrieved means accessible, not fully appraised. Use each source link to open the original page.

R01 OECD Regulatory Policy Outlook 2025 - Regulating for effectiveness

[Open original source](#) | Retrieved; detailed evidence appraisal pending

Evaluation and correction of regulation; phase 1 evidence review.

R02 Opportunities for All - Build efficient and responsive governments

[Open original source](#) | Retrieved; detailed evidence appraisal pending

Capture and responsive government; governance workstream.

R03 Exploring New Frontiers in Citizen Participation - Building Resilient Democracies

[Open original source](#) | Retrieved; detailed evidence appraisal pending

Citizen participation and democratic resilience; consultation design.

R04 The Sequencing and Speed of Reforms in Transition Economies: Implications for the Case of Uzbekistan

[Open original source](#) | Retrieved; detailed evidence appraisal pending

Sequencing and speed; country-specific transition evidence, not proof of a universal path.

R05 Structures, Processes and Governance in Tax Policy-Making - Carlo Cottarelli

[Open original source](#) | Retrieved; claim support needs correction

Previously cited for compensation before disruption. Retrieved page concerns tax policymaking; that specific claim remains unsupported by this citation pending passage review.

Conversation reference register continued

R06 Government at a Glance 2025 - Poverty and inequality

[Open original source](#) | Retrieved; detailed evidence appraisal pending

Baseline inequality and redistribution measures; distinguish association from causal attribution.

R07 Closing the Gap: A LIC's Policy Options Under an Aid Shock

[Open original source](#) | Retrieved; detailed evidence appraisal pending

Fiscal stress scenarios. Model of an aid-dependent economy; do not generalize its results to every country.

R08 Financing gap for universal social protection: Global, regional and national estimates and strategies for creating fiscal space

[Open original source](#) | Retrieved; detailed evidence appraisal pending

Costing social protection and international variation. Page confirms 3.3% and 52.3% GDP estimates; these are contextual estimates, not this project's budget.

R09 Support for Economic Reforms Hinges on Communication, Engagement, and Trust

[Open original source](#) | Retrieved; detailed evidence appraisal pending

Engagement and reform support; investigate study design and limits before extrapolation.

R10 Getting the Public on Side

[Open original source](#) | Retrieved; detailed evidence appraisal pending

Public acceptance and reform design; compare proposed mechanisms.

Conversation reference register continued

R11 Social protection floor

[Open original source](#) | Retrieved; detailed evidence appraisal pending

Definition of a social protection floor; inputs to floor specification.

R12 NHSC Scholarship Program Overview

[Open original source](#) | Retrieved; detailed evidence appraisal pending

Education-for-service precedent in selected health professions; not evidence that a universal scheme would succeed.

R13 US Naval Academy - Admissions Apply

[Open original source](#) | Access blocked; not reverified

Military education precedent cited earlier; blocked with HTTP 403, details not reverified.

R14 How to Comply with Scholarship Program Requirements

[Open original source](#) | Retrieved; detailed evidence appraisal pending

Detailed scholarship obligations; assess scope and current contract conditions separately.

R15 US Naval Academy - Blue and Gold Book Admissions

[Open original source](#) | Access blocked; not reverified

Noncompletion and service agreements cited earlier; blocked with HTTP 403, details not reverified.

Conversation reference register continued

R16 Disability Discrimination and Employment Decisions

[Open original source](#) | Retrieved; detailed evidence appraisal pending

Accessible employment analysis; does not establish that every student can perform every job.

R17 Department of Labor ODEP - Apprenticeship

[Open original source](#) | Access blocked; not reverified

Accessible apprenticeship context; blocked with HTTP 403, content not reverified.

R18 Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities - Article 27 Work and employment

[Open original source](#) | Access blocked; not reverified

Work and disability rights context; blocked with HTTP 403, content not reverified.

R19 Anti-Corruption and Integrity Outlook 2026

[Open original source](#) | Retrieved; detailed evidence appraisal pending

Integrity implementation and institutional capture; governance evidence review.

R20 The ADA: Your Employment Rights as an Individual With a Disability

[Open original source](#) | Retrieved; detailed evidence appraisal pending

Reasonable accommodation and essential job functions; legal applicability needs qualified review.

Evidence gaps carried forward

The conversation also mentioned Army ROTC without a corresponding link. Add an official source before using its contractual terms. Claims about universal program novelty, repayment value, political support, and the economic effects of expanded ownership require additional research. The existing sources do not validate the complete proposed system.